

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



PM RAO'S LEADERSHIP

MODULE - 9

PRAGMATIC NARSIMHA RAO

1 In the 1990s, India witnessed a major economic crisis. Under the leadership of PM Narsimha Rao and financial acumen of Dr Manmohan Singh, India liberalized its economy.

2 He is referred to as the 'father of Indian Economic Reforms'

3 It was the realistic option available considering the disintegration of USSR and the Socialist system.

4 Prime Minister integrated India with fast-growing economies like Japan, South Korea and other Southeast Asian nations.

5 These relations alarmed our neighbours and countries like Pakistan raised anti-India slogans on Kashmir in the Organization of Islamic Nations.



INDIA - ISRAEL

SUCCESSFUL DIPLOMACY

PM Rao is also referred to as the 'Chanakya of Modern India' for taking bold reforms.

- 1 On 29 January, 1992, India established full-fledged diplomatic relations with Israel.
- 2 This was done after India convinced Palestinian leader Arafat of the need for better relationship with Israel.
- 3 Israel was allowed to open an embassy in New Delhi and opened its embassy in Tel Aviv.



INDIA - ISRAEL

SUCCESSFUL DIPLOMACY

- 4 India voted in favour of the UN resolution “Zionism is a form of racism and racial discrimination”. It was however, not received well by the domestic Muslim population
- 5 Thus diplomatic relations were established with Israel and balance with Palestine was maintained.

India's relations with Israel showcase that Silent diplomacy and how Track II relations help in developing stronger and deeper ties than Track I exchanges.



INDIA - IRAN

SECURING ENERGY NEEDS

- 1 Iranian President Rafsanjani made a State visit to India in April 1995. It was a hundred member delegation to discuss matters of mutual interest with Indian PM Rao.
- 2 The past similarity of being dominated and hard earned independence were being emphasized.
- 3 Iranian President wanted India and Iran to co-operate in maintaining peace and stability in the Middle East.



INDIA - IRAN

SECURING ENERGY NEEDS

4 Both countries agreed that in order to achieve this, the menace of terrorism had to be curtailed and weapons of mass destruction had to be restricted

5 Because of India's Iran policy and good relations, Iran opposed the UN Human Rights Commission in Geneva on the human rights situation in Jammu & Kashmir.



INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

INDIA'S NUCLEAR PROGRAM

ONLY PREPARING, NOT FIRING

- 1 PM Rao worked towards the national nuclear security and ballistic missiles program, which ultimately resulted in the 1998 Pokhran nuclear tests.
- 2 He had increased military spending and prepared the Indian Army to fight the threat of terrorism and insurgencies, and address Pakistan and China's nuclear potentials.
- 3 PM weighed India's interest in nuclear security vis-à-vis cost of the test to India's other interests.
- 4 India had adopted a policy of "nuclear opacity" similar to that practiced by Israel.
- 5 With this India could create a deterrent effect through an advanced nuclear capability, while avoiding the political and economic costs by refusing to openly acknowledge that it had progressed to full weaponization.



INDIA'S NUCLEAR PROGRAM

BALANCING PRIORITIES

- 1 US, Japan and EU were threatening economic sanctions if India conducted the nuclear test.
- 2 PM Rao was thus strongly against overt declarations of nuclear capability that would incur crippling sanctions.
- 3 But Pakistan's weapons program ultimately led to India to manufacture an arsenal of weapons.
- 4 In spite of US surveillance India tested a short-range ballistic missile.



INDIA'S NUCLEAR PROGRAM

BALANCING PRIORITIES

- 5 On 13 April 1995, PM Rao authorized 6 billion rupees for the development of the Agni II.
- 6 Abdul Kalam was asked to expedite work on setting up a sophisticated command and control system for India's nuclear weapons, and to build additional weapon storage sites around the country.
- 7 India and US conducted the first ever joint naval exercise in May 1992.



INDIA - SOUTHEAST ASIA

LOOK EAST POLICY

- 1 PM Rao enacted the Look East policy to revived strategic and economic ties with South-East Asia. It ultimately evolved into a cornerstone of India's strategic doctrine.
- 2 Under this policy, India strengthened its engagement with Association of South east Asian nations(ASEAN).
- 3 The objective was developing political contacts, increasing economic integration and forging security cooperation with countries of Southeast Asia.

It was thus, the time when India re-evaluated and strategically shifted its economic and foreign policy.

- 4 It was an attempt to strengthen India's position as a regional power.



NEW CHAPTER IN INDIA'S FOREIGN POLICY

- 1 Look East Policy recognized the strategic and economic importance of Southeast Asia to India's national interests being recognized.
- 2 It was aimed to counterweight to China's growing strategic influence in the region.
- 3 For the newly liberalized economy, engagement with ASEAN would attract investment.



NEW CHAPTER IN INDIA'S FOREIGN POLICY

4 To further this, PM Rao visited Singapore, Malaysia, Thailand and Vietnam and deepened the relationship.

5 In 1992, he spoke in Singapore about old cultural ties and new economic opportunities.

6 By 2001, India also became an East Asian Summit partner

The current Act East policy, is an extension of Rao's Look east Policy.



INDIA - CHINA

FALLING PREY TO CHINA

PM Rao was greatly impressed with Deng Xiaoping and his expertise in giving a new direction to Chinese political philosophy while reconciling with the past. Prime Minister Narasimha Rao's 1993 visit to China complicated the border resolution.

- 1 PM Rao like PM Nehru approach of minor territorial (sectoral) adjustments instead of a comprehensive solution on border resolution.
- 2 China said that the entire border should be called the Line of Actual Control, without prejudice to the border positions of the two sides.



INDIA - CHINA

FALLING PREY TO CHINA

- 3 China told India that troops could be withdrawn sector-wise inspite of dispute along the border areas
- 4 PM Rao did not consult the Army and failed to understand that the Line of Actual Control by definition would be easier to alter than a disputed border even if it was not agreed on maps or on the ground. Being a military-held line, it can be changed by force.



INDIA - CHINA

LINE OF ACTUAL CONTROL

1 The two sides signed the **Border Peace and Tranquillity Agreement** during the Prime Minister's China visit in **September 1993**.

2 The entire disputed border was **renamed the Line of Actual Control**.

3 In the Eastern Sector, India continued to refer to the border as **the McMahon line**, a colonial term unacceptable to China.

4 Thus, after the **signing of the Border Peace and Tranquillity Agreement**, the disputed border acquired three lines:

5 The border as perceived by China; the border as understood by India; and the Line of Actual Control as agreed by both.



INDIA - CHINA

OUTCOME OF AGREEMENT

- 1 After the agreement was signed, and especially after India's nuclear tests in 1998, the number of Chinese transgressions inside Indian territories increased.
- 2 Since 1998, Chinese activities both in the Western and Eastern sectors continued to be aimed at asserting their claims up to their perception of the LAC irrespective of the mutually agreed disputed areas.
- 3 These movements were indicative of the Chinese intention of asserting their claim as part of a well-designed plan.
- 4 The agreement also resulted in the Sino-Indian Joint Working Group on Boundary Question, to close four closest military posts on the border and to set up four border trade ports besides four meeting points between their armies.



INDIA - NEPAL

INDO-NEPAL ON MAHAKALI RIVER

- 1 On 12 February 1996, the Nepali PM Deuba and Indian PM Rao signed an agreement on the integrated development of the Mahakali river.
- 2 It concerned the Integrated Development of the Mahakali River including Sarada Barrage, Tanakpur Barrage and Pancheshwar Project
- 3 The objective was to strengthen bilateral relations and promote cooperation in the development of water resources.
- 4 Nepal's agricultural, industrial, service and other sectors were expected to flourish with the huge amount of power
- 5 India would also be able to feed its industrial projects



INDIA - NEPAL

MAHAKALI RIVER PROJECT

- 1** The Pancheshwor Project under the Treaty was expected to produce 6,000 MW of hydro-power with the investment cost of US \$ 4 billion till 2002 .
- 2** The costs would be borne by both countries.
- 3** There was also provision for irrigation of vast tract of agricultural land and flood control in Nepal and India.
- 4** India signed a pact recently to set up Pancheshwor Development Authority (PDA).
- 5** It is this body that is expected to commission the Pancheshwor Multipurpose Project,



SAARC

ECONOMIC COOPERATION

- 1 The Sixth SAARC Summit was held on 21 December, 1991 in Colombo. During this Summit, the leaders agreed to liberalise trade in the region.
- 2 PM Rao from India proposed a “collective economic security system” to strengthen the economies of the developing countries.
- 3 A need was felt to frame an agreement listing the measures for trade liberalization among SAARC countries.
- 4 Sri Lanka had proposed The South Asian Preferential Trade Agreement(SAPTA) in 1997.

SAPTA

stands for

**South Asian Preferential
Trade Agreement**

SAARC

PREFERENTIAL TRADE AGREEMENT

- 1 Hence the seeds for an institutional agreement within SAARC to facilitate trade between member countries was laid.
- 2 This ultimately led to the signing of SAPTA at the seventh SAARC Summit.
- 3 PM Rao hoped that there would be zero custom trading in South Asia.
- 4 Beside economic cooperation, countries were urged to cooperate for protection and conservation of environment.



INDIA - PAKISTAN

KASHMIR ISSUE INTERNATIONALIZED

Kashmir continued to be an area of tension between India and Pakistan.

1 During the 1990s the infiltration of Pakistan backed terrorists in Kashmir and proxy wars was increasing.

2 In February 1990, the Pakistani parliament passed a resolution which rejected the Jammu and Kashmir's accession to India and even demanded UN resolution for it.

3 PM Rao suggested resolution of the issue bilaterally. But Pakistan with US support, was successful in internationalising the Kashmir Issue.



INDIA - PAKISTAN

INDIA'S RESPONSE

- To counter Pakistan's resolution, the Indian parliament unanimously passed Kashmir Resolution on 22 February 1994. According to the resolution, the Indian Parliament declared.

- 1 The State of Jammu & Kashmir would continue to be an integral part of India
- 2 Attempts to separate it from the rest of the country will be resisted by all necessary means
- 3 Pakistan must vacate the areas of the Indian State of Jammu and Kashmir, which they have occupied through aggression

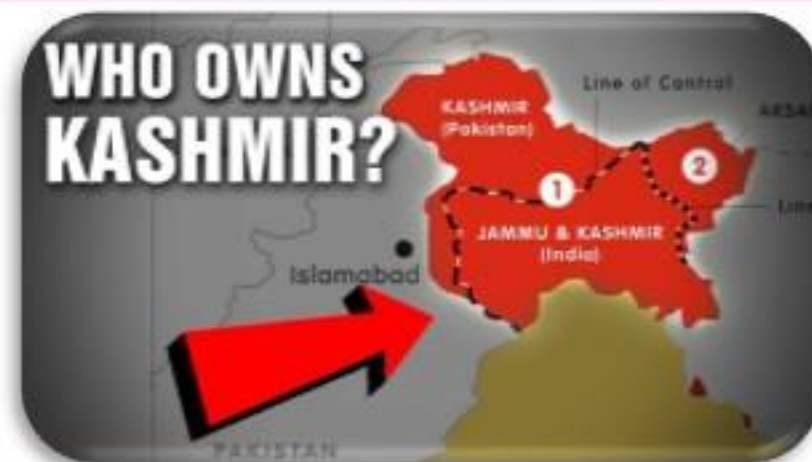


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INDIA - PAKISTAN

RESOLUTION AT UN

- 1** This resolution got support from US as the US President in his UN General Assembly address referred to Kashmir as 'disputed'.
- 2** India felt that there was an international coup to dislodge the Indian government from Kashmir.
- 3** The Organisation of Islamic Countries also wanted to look at the ground level when Pakistan claimed that Kashmiri Muslims were oppressed by Indian Army.
- 4** On 27 February 1994, Pakistan moved to UN Human Rights Commission and tabled the resolution through OIC that condemned India for violation of human rights in Kashmir in Geneva. If the resolution would have passed, India would have been put on UNSC economic sanctions.



INDIA - PAKISTAN

INDIA'S RESPONSE

In response, PM Rao formed a team of delegates, all carefully chosen to represent India comprising of

- 1
 - Atal Bihari, Finance Minister Manmohan Singh to represent India at Geneva and United Nations.
 - Hurriyat men to represent UNHRC as non-governmental presence.
 - Ambassadors influential with OIC member countries also participated
 - Inclusion of Muslim delegates dismantled the claims of oppression of Kashmiri Muslims in India.

- 2 As for Chinese support, an Indian diplomat voted in favor of Beijing at UN on a resolution based on a different matter. By this, India ensured China's support at the UNHRC resolution.



INDIA - PAKISTAN

INDIA TURNS VICTORIOUS

- 1 On the day of Resolution, most of the countries that Pakistan expected would favour the country had backtracked.
- 2 Indonesia and Libya withdrew support to OIC Resolution, Syria escaped saying it would reconsider the revised draft.
- 3 China and Iran voted in favour of India.
- 4 Pakistan was compelled to withdraw the resolution.



TERRORIST ACTIVITY

MUMBAI BLASTS

- 1** In March 1993, Mumbai witnessed a series of bombings. Indian intelligence showed evidence of Pakistan's support and sponsorship of terrorism against India.
- 2** In response, PM Rao invited counter-terrorism experts from the US, United Kingdom and other Western countries to visit the spot and witness the evidence.
- 3** All information was kept open to public and he spoke against the Pakistani establishment.
- 4** He wanted to systematically draw world attention towards Pakistan.



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